

Day 1 — Friends to Ten

Module: Friends to Ten (Primary) · **Time:** 35 min

Goal

Children meet “friends to ten” through a chant, a story, and a card game. By end of class they can name at least three friend-pairs.

Materials

- A deck of number cards 0–9 (4 of each = 40 cards) per pair
- Drawing paper + crayons
- “Friends to Ten” wall poster (5 colourful pairs)

The flow

Settle + chant (5 min)

Sit on the mat. Teacher: > *“For the next two weeks we’ll meet some friends. They’re tiny — but very important. Numbers have friends too.”*

Teach the chant (3 times, claps on each pair):

“1 and 9 are friends! 2 and 8 are friends! 3 and 7 are friends! 4 and 6 are friends! 5 and 5 are best friends! All make TEN!”

Story (5 min)

The Friend Game

Ten little ants lived on a leaf. Sometimes they walked off in groups.

One day, 3 ants walked off. (*Hold up 3 fingers.*) How many were left behind on the leaf? (*Wait. Children call out: 7!*)

Yes! 3 and 7 are friends. They always make 10 together.

Another day, 6 ants walked off. (*Hold up 6.*) How many on the leaf? (*4!*)

6 and 4 are friends. Always 10.

Every number from 0 to 10 has a friend. We’ll meet them all today.

Card game: Make Ten (20 min)

How to play (paired):

1. Shuffle. Deal 5 cards to each player. Put 5 face-up in the middle.
2. On your turn:
 - Look at your hand and the middle.
 - Find two cards that are friends (add to 10).

- Take both. Put in your pile.
- Draw 1 from the deck.
- 3. If you can't make 10, place 1 card in the middle. End turn.
- 4. When the deck runs out, count pairs. Most pairs wins.

Play 2–3 rounds.

Show + chant (5 min)

- “Who won a round?” — winner shares ONE friend pair they made.
- Class chants the pair: “6 and 4 are friends!”
- Close with the daily chant.

Homework / take-home

- Practise the chant with a sibling or parent. Win a round of Make Ten with family!

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Use 0–9 cards including 0+10 pairs.
- **Tier down:** Use cards 1–6 to keep pairs simple.

Teacher's quick notes

- Some children won't find pairs and will give up. Pair them with a stronger player as a “team.”
- Same game as Module 5 — children may come in already half-knowing it. Affirm and add the *friend* framing.
- The “friend” language is the bridge to subtraction. By Day 4 we'll say “to find 100 minus 7, ask: who's 7's friend? 3. Then put a 9 in front. 93.”

Teacher note on Sanskrit

We don't introduce *Nikhilam* yet. The word appears on Day 3 as a “magic word.” Today is just about friends.